

After-Hours Guest Coverage Checklist

Audit your overnight and weekend gaps before they cost you bookings or reviews.

Use this checklist to assess how well your current after-hours setup covers overnight calls, weekend gaps, emergency escalation, and morning handoff. Work through each section and note what is in place, what is missing, and what needs to be formalised.

1. COVERAGE HOURS — DEFINE YOUR WINDOW

Front desk closes at: _____

Front desk reopens at: _____

Weekend / holiday hours differ: _____

Who is responsible for after-hours phone coverage currently: _____

- ☐ Coverage hours are clearly defined and documented, not assumed.
- ☐ All team members know the exact handoff time and process.
- ☐ Holiday and peak-season coverage windows are agreed in advance.
- ☐ Call routing is configured to reflect the coverage schedule automatically.

2. INBOUND CALL HANDLING

- ☐ A live person answers calls during all defined coverage hours — no voicemail during covered windows.
- ☐ After-hours calls are answered with the correct property greeting, not a generic message.
- ☐ The call handler knows your current rates, room types, and basic availability.
- ☐ The handler can confirm, modify, or take payment for reservations without transferring.
- ☐ Calls outside covered hours have a clear voicemail or callback process.
- ☐ Call answer time target is defined (e.g., within 15 seconds or 3 rings).
- ☐ All inbound calls are logged with caller name, number, call type, and outcome.

3. NIGHT AUDIT PHONE COVERAGE

- ☐ Night audit calls (billing questions, late charges, audit queries) are handled live, not deferred to morning.

- ☐ The handler understands what night audit calls typically involve and can answer or log correctly.
- ☐ Disputes or rate queries during audit hours are logged and escalated correctly, not resolved without authorisation.
- ☐ Morning team receives a clear summary of any audit-related calls before their shift starts.

4. EMERGENCY ESCALATION PROTOCOL

On-call contact name: _____

On-call contact number: _____

Backup escalation contact: _____

Maintenance emergency contact: _____

- ☐ A written escalation protocol exists and is accessible to the after-hours handler at all times.
- ☐ Categories of genuine emergencies are clearly defined (medical, fire, security, major maintenance).
- ☐ Non-emergencies that feel urgent (unhappy guest, minor complaint) are not escalating to on-call unnecessarily.
- ☐ Emergency services protocol: handler knows to call 911 first before notifying management for medical/safety events.
- ☐ Escalation is confirmed — handler waits for acknowledgement, does not simply leave a voicemail and disconnect.
- ☐ All escalations are logged with timestamp, issue type, action taken, and outcome.

5. GUEST REQUESTS DURING COVERED HOURS

- ☐ Late checkout requests: handler can check availability and confirm at defined rates without GM approval.
- ☐ Early check-in inquiries: handler can check and respond accurately, not just promise availability.
- ☐ Lock-out situations: handler knows the protocol (front desk on-call, spare key policy, security contact).
- ☐ Room change requests: handler knows what to log and when to escalate versus resolve.
- ☐ Complaint calls: handler can acknowledge, apologise, log, and route correctly without inflaming the situation.
- ☐ Special occasion requests: handler knows what the property offers and at what cost.

6. MORNING HANDOFF PROCESS

Morning summary delivered by: _____

Delivered at: _____

Delivered to: _____

- ☐ Morning team receives a written summary of overnight activity before their shift starts.
- ☐ Summary includes: all calls handled, all messages received, escalations triggered, any open issues.
- ☐ Unresolved matters (pending escalation responses, guest callbacks due) are flagged clearly.
- ☐ Nothing that happened overnight is a surprise to the morning team.

7. SLA TARGETS

CHANNEL	TARGET RESPONSE	YOUR CURRENT STANDARD
Inbound calls	< 15 seconds / 3 rings	_____
SMS messages	< 15 minutes	_____
WhatsApp	< 15 minutes	_____
OTA messages	< 30 minutes	_____
Email	< 60 minutes	_____
Escalation acknowledgement	< 5 minutes	_____

Want GuestSquad to cover your after-hours gaps?

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